Version 2.0 | 2026-11-06 | Current

Selection Criteria

Part A: How I chose what goes in this portfolio

The most important criterion for choosing portfolio work is distinguishing between two skills that often get combined: the ability to execute correctly within a structure someone else built, and the ability to build or choose the structure myself. These are different competencies, even though the finished product can look identical on the page. A perfectly formatted accession record or policy produced from a template the instructor provided, applying a standard the instructor named, or describing a collection that was already laid out, demonstrates that I can follow instructions well. It isn't evidence of independent archival judgement. I essentially 'inherited' a decision-making exercise and executed it. Stronger evidence is any piece of work where I made and defended those calls.

My selection rules

1. Each of the nine competency components gets one main artifact. If I have both coursework and hands-on work for a component, I show and label both.
2. Every artifact has to be viewable inside the portfolio itself.
3. When I have both, I prefer real work for the Savannah Municipal Archives over coursework.
4. I include only material I have permission to share. *See Ethics and Permissions.*

What I left out, and why

1. Museum Presentation: too large for GitHub. Replaced by the Strategic Plan coursework. Can be sent upon request.
2. Hands-on physical preservation work from my preservation course: shows that I can perform basic preservation analysis and techniques; does not prove that I have applied this knowledge in a real archival setting.
3. My coursework in ArchivesSpace: shows that I can input provided data; does not prove that I can determine description and arrangement when processing a collection.
4. Series of twelve blog posts for the Savannah Municipal Archives focused on the Civil Rights Movement in Savannah: not all posts are published yet. To visit the Archives' blog, click here: https://www.savannahga.gov/Blog.aspx?CID=12

What my selection makes invisible

The portfolio shows description and digitization much more than physical preservation; it shows no live reference work with patrons; the born-digital example is a transfer record, not a worked

case; hands-on handling of paper and bound materials; the voices of the people in the collections come through only in finding-aid notes.

Absences and underrepresented voices

I became an archivist to make sure underrepresented voices are preserved for future researchers. That commitment means looking honestly at my own portfolio, too.

The hands-on work here comes from the City of Savannah Office of Municipal Archives and History: W. W. Law NAACP Collection, the Rev. Southall Brown Collection, the Mike Williams Art Collection, the Joanna B. Flynn Civil Defense Collection, and the Historic Savannah Maps. My coursework artifacts are set in fictional institutions, so they hold no community voices at all.

The people in these collections rarely speak here in their own words. They appear mainly through finding-aid notes and catalog records that others and I wrote about them. The W. W. Law materials center on a well-known leader, while the members, families, and young people who carried Savannah's Civil Rights Movement appear far less. The first-person voices I did work with, the audiocassette recordings I digitized, exist in the Archives' system, so this portfolio can describe them but cannot hold them.

Some of these gaps come from the records themselves. A municipal archive holds what offices and donors chose to keep, and everyday lives were less often written down or donated. Other gaps come from my own selection rules. I included only what I could show and had permission to share. I also left out twelve blog posts on Savannah's Civil Rights Movement because not all of them are published yet, and that choice removed Civil Rights stories from this portfolio.

These absences matter most to the communities themselves. When people appear only through someone else's description, they are not heard on their own terms, and researchers meet them secondhand. For Black Savannahians, the record risks telling the story of a movement through its leaders and institutions rather than through the people who live it.

Where I could, I chose work that pushes against these gaps: the Rev. Southall Brown finding aid, the W. W. Law lesson plans, and StoryRoots. I also tagged related work "community archives" and "civil rights" so it can be found together. What this portfolio cannot do is add voices that were never collected. That takes oral history and community-led collecting, and it is the work I want to do next.

Part B: How I managed building this portfolio

Timeline (from the Build Log)

Date	What happened
2026-10-01	Version naming applied to all files. Museum Presentation replaced because of the file-size limit.

2026-10-12	Fingerprint (checksum) list created. First round of PastPerfect link checks.
2026-10-14	Lesson plans added to Outreach and Advocacy.
2026-10-22	Rubric self-score completed. Gaps found. This plan written.
2026-11-06	Fixed remaining gaps.

Risks I identified and what I did

Risk	What happened or could happen	My response
File too large for GitHub	Happened 2026-10-01	Replaced the file; rule 2 above
PastPerfect items are outside my control	Links could break or items could be removed	Link checks on a schedule; contact the Archives if one fails
Fingerprint list falls out of date when files are renamed	Happened: the list still named old file names on 2026-10-22	Rebuilt on 2026-10-24; rebuild any time files change
Losing GitHub or my account	Portfolio would disappear	Second copy kept on external hard drive; last updated 2026-11-06. Third copy kept on my computer; last updated 2026-11-06
Permission withdrawn for an item	Item has to come down	Remove it, note it in the Build Log

How this connects to running an archives program

A small archive with one or two staff would use the same habits, which are deciding what items to include in the Archives, estimating time, writing down risks, checking on a schedule, and keeping a log of decisions.